OWNER'S MANUAL

Ardena T3

Touring bicycle · frame sizes 50 to 60 cm

EDITION 2 · READ BEFORE THE FIRST RIDE

This manual covers the T3 as it leaves the shop: a steel touring frame, 700C wheels, cable disc brakes and a 2 × 10 drivetrain. Read **section 1** before you ride. The rest of the manual is arranged by part of the bicycle, and every reference to another section gives its page.

- **1 Before your first ride**, page **2**
- **2 Wheels and tyres**, page **2**
- **3 Brakes**, page **3**
- **4 Gears and chain**, page **4**
- **5 Maintenance schedule**, page **4**

1 Before your first ride

1.1 Checks before every ride

A check takes two minutes and finds most faults before they find you. Lift each end of the bicycle and spin the wheel: it should run true and stop slowly, without rubbing. Squeeze each brake lever; it should stop well short of the handlebar. If a lever reaches the bar, do not ride: see **section 3.2** on **page 3**.

Press each tyre hard with your thumb. A tyre that gives easily needs air; the pressures are in **section 2.1**, **page 2**. Finally, check that both quick-release levers are closed and point backwards, as **close the lever** in **section 2.2** describes.

1.2 Setting the saddle height

1. Sit on the saddle with one heel on the pedal at the bottom of its stroke.
2. Raise or lower the saddle until that leg is straight, without rocking your hips.
3. Tighten the seat-post bolt to 5 N·m with a torque wrench. Never raise the saddle above the **MIN INSERT** mark on the post.

2 Wheels and tyres

2.1 Tyre pressure

The tyres are 700 × 38 mm. Run them between 3.5 and 5 bar: the lower figure for a rider under 70 kg or for gravel, the higher one for a loaded bicycle on tarmac. Check the pressure once a week with a gauge; a tyre loses about half a bar a week through the tube alone.

Never pump a tyre above 5 bar. The rim and the tyre are rated for that pressure together, and a tyre that leaves the rim at speed throws the rider.

2.2 Removing and fitting the front wheel

1. Shift to the smallest rear sprocket, so the chain is slack if you remove the rear wheel later.
2. Open the quick-release lever, no tools needed, and unscrew the nut on the other side by three turns.
3. Lift the front of the bicycle and let the wheel drop out of the fork.

To fit it, reverse the steps. Seat the axle fully in both fork ends, tighten the nut until the lever meets resistance halfway through its swing, then close the lever so that it points backwards. With the wheel back, squeeze the front brake twice; if the lever feels soft, the pads may have moved, and **section 3.3** on **page 4** explains how to set them again.

3 Brakes

3.1 How the brakes work

The T3 has mechanical disc brakes. Each lever pulls a cable that pushes one pad against a steel rotor; the second pad is fixed, and the rotor flexes towards it. New pads need bedding in: ride at walking pace, brake firmly to a stop ten times on each wheel, and the pads will reach full power.

> **WET WEATHER**
>
> Disc brakes stop in the rain, but the first turn of the wheel only clears water from the rotor. Brake a little earlier than usual, and keep oil and chain lube away from the rotors: a contaminated pad cannot be cleaned and must be replaced.

3.2 Checking pad wear

Look into the caliper from above with a torch. Each pad has a steel backing plate and a layer of braking material. Replace both pads of a wheel when the material is thinner than 1 mm, or when a scraping noise tells you the backing plate has reached the rotor. Fit pads of the same type: the T3 uses resin pads, code AR-P2.

After fitting new pads, adjust the cable as in **section 3.3** and bed them in as described on **page 3**.

3.3 Adjusting the cable

As the pads wear, the lever travels further. Turn the barrel adjuster at the lever anticlockwise, half a turn at a time, until the lever stops about 2 cm from the bar. If the adjuster runs out of thread, screw it back in, loosen the cable clamp bolt on the caliper, pull 2 mm of cable through and tighten the clamp bolt to 6 N·m. Then squeeze the lever hard ten times and check its travel again.

4 Gears and chain

4.1 Cleaning and oiling the chain

A clean chain lasts three times as long as a dirty one. Every 500 km, or after any wet ride, wipe the chain with a dry cloth while you turn the pedals backwards. Put one drop of chain oil on each roller, turn the pedals for a minute, and wipe off what the outside of the chain still carries. Oil on the outside picks up grit; oil inside the rollers does the work. Keep the oil off the rotors, as **Wet weather** on **page 3** explains.

5 Maintenance schedule

- **Before every ride:** the checks in **section 1.1**, page **2**.
- **Every week:** tyre pressure, **page 2**.
- **Every 500 km:** clean and oil the chain, **page 4**.
- **Every 1,000 km:** pad wear and cable travel, **section 3** from **page 3**; the seat-post bolt, **page 2**.
- **Every 3,000 km:** chain wear, and a full service at an Ardena dealer.

The pressure warning on **page 2** applies to the replacement tyres as well.

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